

China Oil, Gas and Chemical Sector

Weekly tracker: Refinery utilisation and crude inventory still declining; eyes on fluorochemicals

Equities

China
Chemicals

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Refining: Teapot refineries' utilisation declined to 45.74%

SOE refineries' average utilisation edged up 0.23ppt WoW to 67.41% last week. Utilisation at teapot refineries continued to decline by 2.9ppt WoW to 45.74%. China's total crude throughput fell 128 kb/d WoW to 12,321kb/d by last week. As per Kpler data, overall China crude inventory has been declining since early June and is at 1,268MMbbl as of 22 June.

Chemicals: Polyester filament utilisation declined 2ppt/15ppt WoW/YoY

Ethylene: Naphtha-based ethylene utilisation was broadly flat WoW at 76%, while MTO route utilisation declined 5ppt/11ppt WoW/YoY to 78%. **Polyolefins:** PE utilisation was flat WoW, at 80% (down 1ppt YoY), while PP utilisation decreased 1ppt/15ppt WoW/YoY to 63%. **PDH** utilisation increased 3ppt WoW to 66%. **PVC** utilisation increased 1ppt WoW to 70% (down 9ppt YoY). **Aromatics chain:** PX utilisation was flat WoW, at 77% (down 8ppt YoY), while PTA utilisation increased 4ppt WoW to 69% (down 13ppt YoY). Polyester filament utilisation declined 2ppt/15ppt WoW/YoY to 74%. **TDI** utilisation rose 7ppt WoW to 71%, while **MDI** utilisation declined 1ppt WoW to 82%. **TiO2** utilisation was flat WoW, at 80%.

PP/PE/silicone DMC inventory fell WoW

According to sample inventory data, PP inventory decreased 2%/26% WoW/YoY to 452kt. PE inventory declined 1% WoW and 5% YoY to 476kt. PVC inventory increased 1% WoW but declined 21% YoY to 415kt. TiO2 inventory rose 8% WoW but declined 43% YoY to 181kt. Polyester filament inventory rose 10%/112% WoW/YoY. Silicone DMC inventory declined 4% WoW and 21% YoY to 40kt.

Stock picks

We prefer beneficiaries of easing Middle East tension, including: 1) companies impacted by raw material prices, such as polyester filament (Tongkun; Buy) and phosphate chemicals; and 2) chemicals leaders with re-rating potential (Wanhua and Yangnong; both Buy). We published a [fluorochemical sector note](#), highlighting applications of fluorochemicals in semiconductors and data centers. We expect fast growth in the AI-related applications of fluorochemicals, amidst the higher compute power demand and the iteration of material systems induced by AI developments. Currently, fluorochemical material suppliers are trading at a notable discount to electronic chemical material firms. We think the market has yet to fully price in the growth opportunities that AI brings to fluorochemical materials and see further re-rating potential for select fluorochemical firms poised to ride the AI tailwinds.

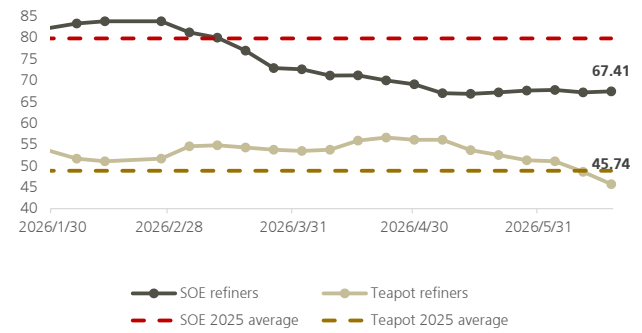
Crude inventory and refinery utilisation

Figure 1: China crude oil inventory



Source: Kpler, UBS

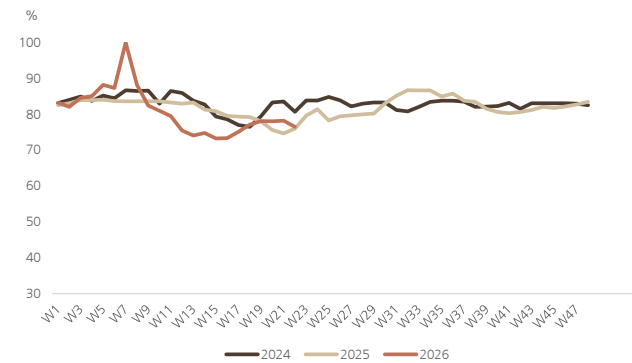
Figure 2: Utilisation of China SOE/teapot refiners



Source: SCI99, Wind

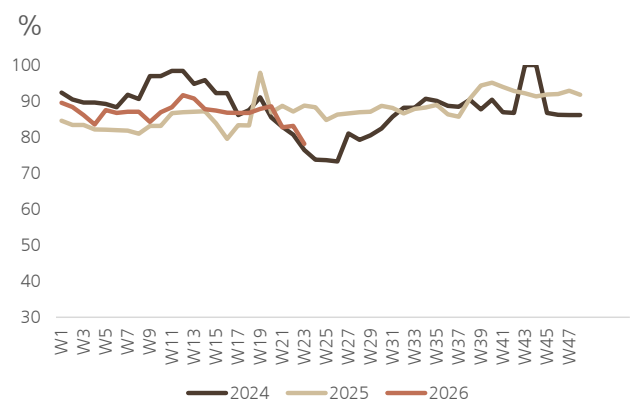
Chemical utilisation

Figure 3: China ethylene (naphtha cracking) capacity utilisation



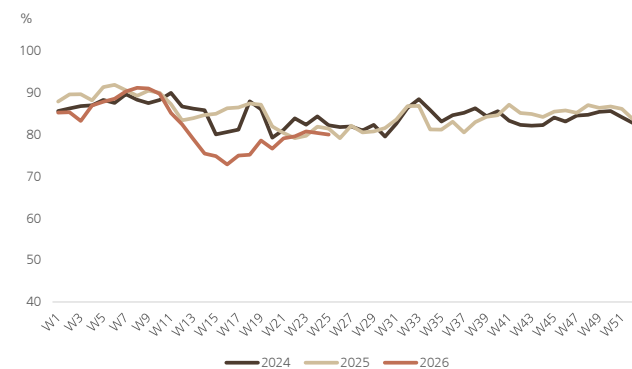
Source: Wind, Oilchem

Figure 4: China ethylene (MTO) capacity utilisation



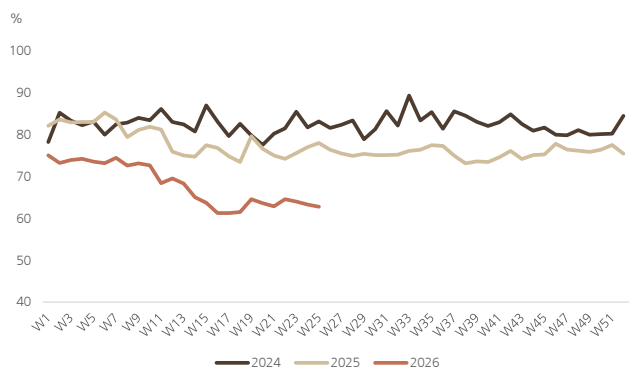
Source: Wind, Oilchem

Figure 5: China PE capacity utilisation



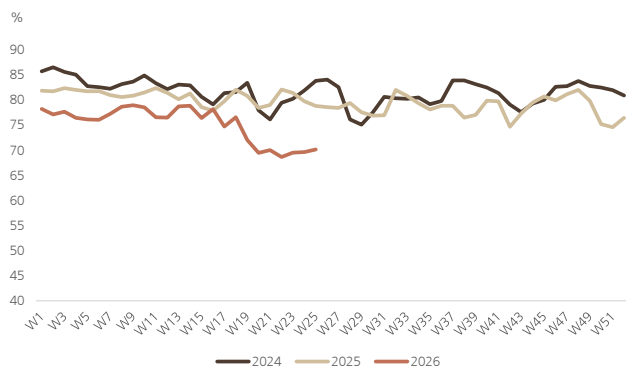
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 6: China PP capacity utilisation



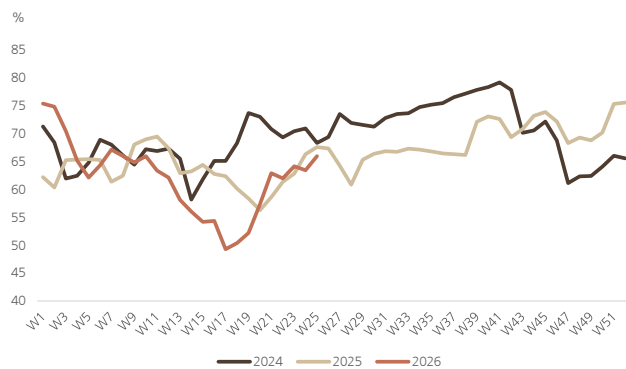
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 7: China PVC capacity utilisation



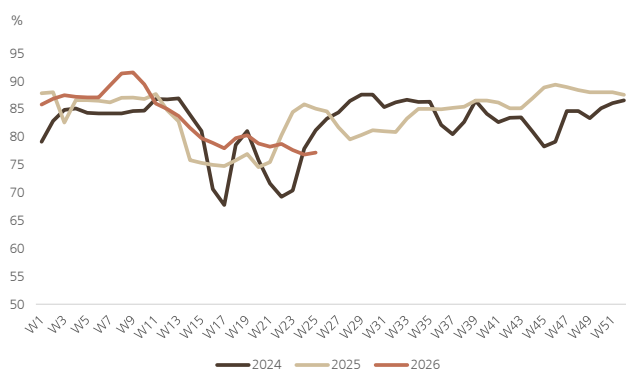
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 8: China PDH capacity utilisation



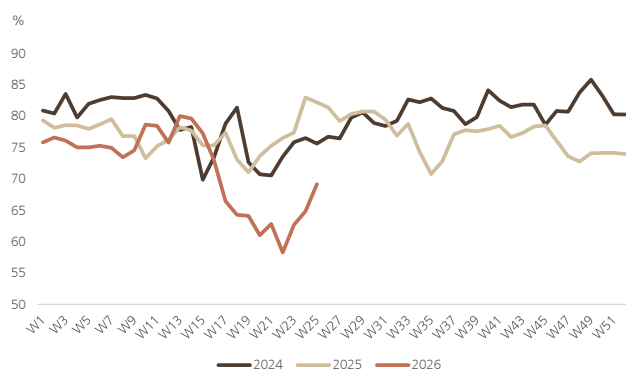
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 9: China PX capacity utilisation



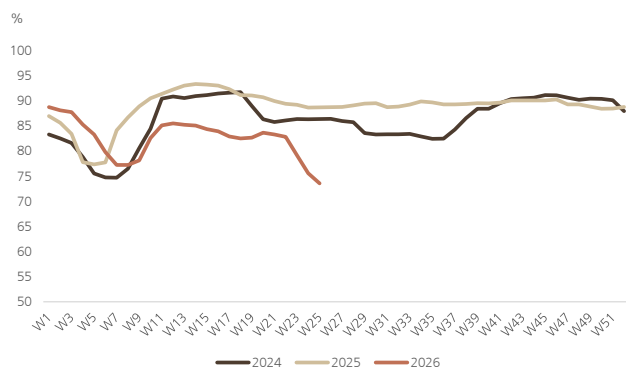
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 10: China PTA capacity utilisation



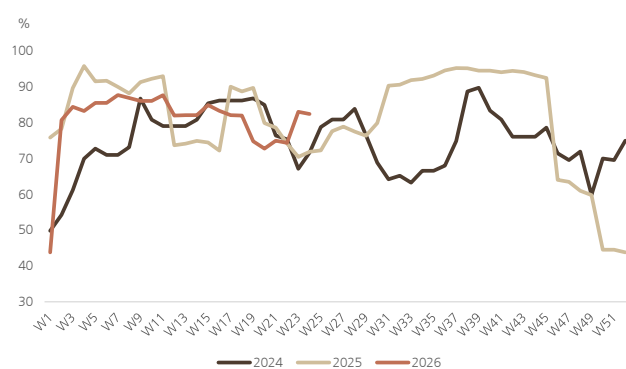
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 11: China Polyester filament capacity utilisation



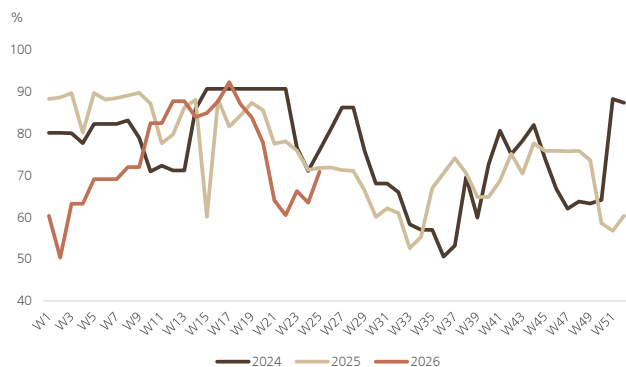
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 12: China MDI capacity utilisation



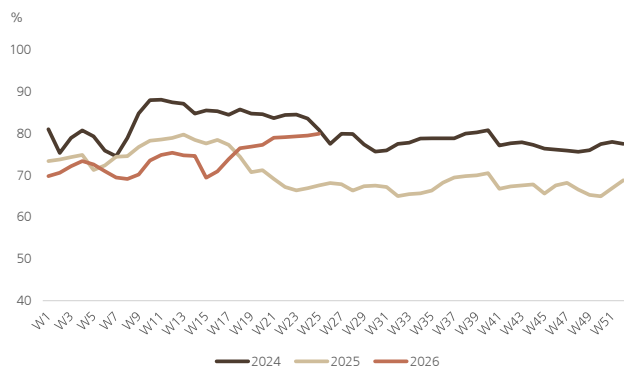
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 13: China TDI capacity utilisation



Source: Baiinfo

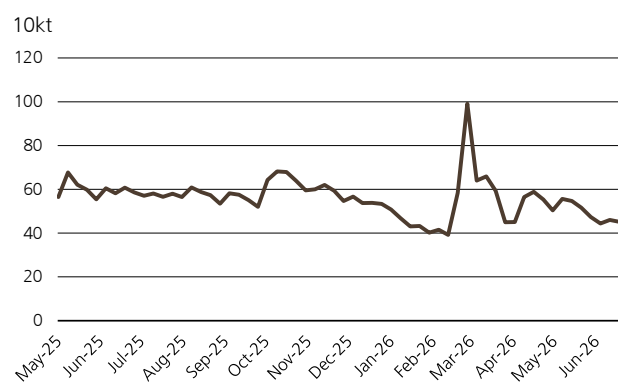
Figure 14: China TiO2 capacity utilisation



Source: Baiinfo

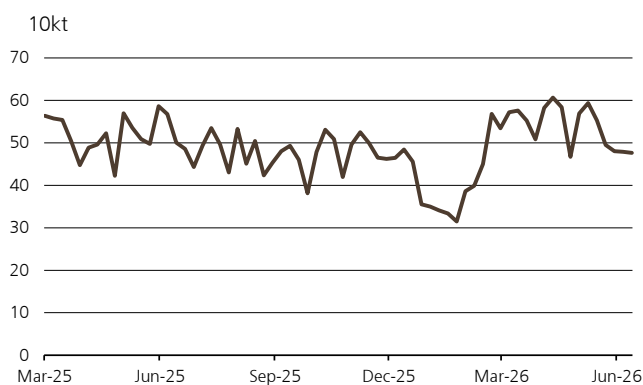
Inventory

Figure 15: Sample factories' inventory of PP



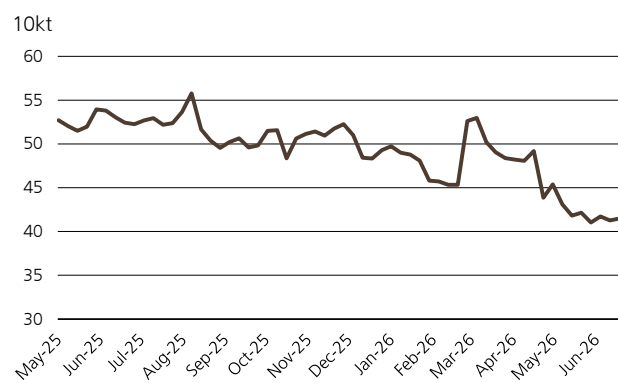
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 16: Sample factories' inventory of PE



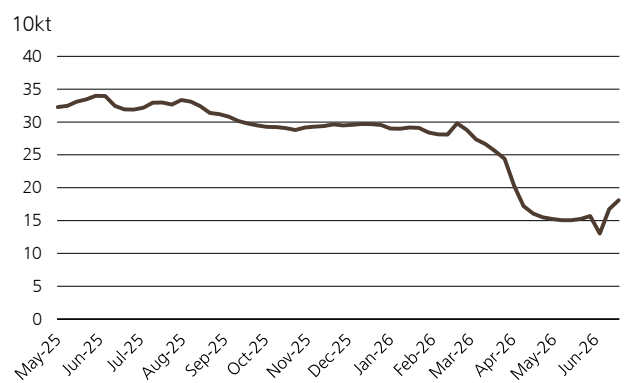
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 17: Sample factories' inventory of PVC



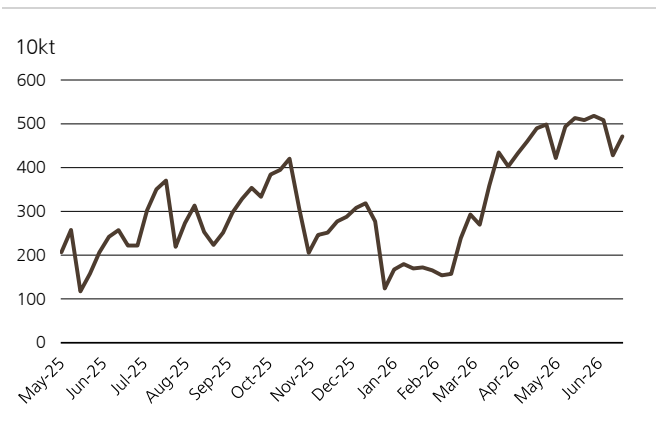
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 18: Sample factories' inventory of TiO2



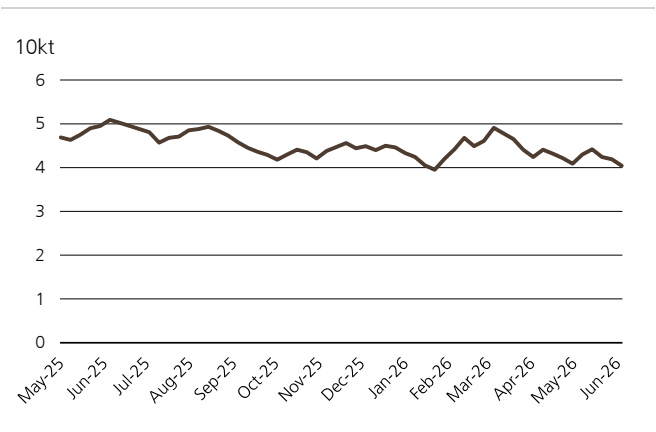
Source: Baiinfo

Figure 19: Sample factories' inventory of polyester filament



Source: Baiinfo

Figure 20: Sample factories' inventory of silicone DMC



Source: Baiinfo

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

O&G sector: We believe risks include: 1) declines or fluctuations in crude oil prices; 2) disappointing reserves and productivity enhancements; and 3) declining prices of major petrochemical products.

Chemicals sector: We believe risks include: 1) large earnings fluctuations due to changes in international oil prices; 2) risks to demand for chemicals due to macro uncertainty; and 3) new capacity coming online faster than expected, leading to sharp weakening of chemical fundamentals.

Wanhua Chemical: We base our price target on a DCF methodology. We believe key downside risks include: 1) an economic downturn leading to declining MDI demand; 2) a price war among MDI leaders during capacity expansion leading to significant decreases in MDI prices; 3) sluggish petrochemical fundamentals in China, causing Wanhua's petrochemical profit to be lower than expected; 4) other leaders achieving MDI technological breakthroughs; and 5) uncertainties around the development of the new materials segment, such as know-how, policies and the investment environment.

We value Yangnong Chemical on DCF. Key downside risks include: 1) new technologies or new offerings could emerge as pesticide makers continue to iterate on products, potentially disrupting the existing market landscape; 2) the pesticide sector is strongly affected by policies, and product bans, etc. could negatively impact earnings; 3) Yangnong is exposed to FX risk given its high mix of export revenue; and 4) pesticide industry dynamics could change due to frequent consolidation/spin-offs.

We use P/BV versus ROE methodology to value Tongkun. The company's key risks include: 1) polyester demand is vulnerable to macro uncertainty; 2) continued deterioration of PTA fundamentals due to new capacity; 3) uncertainty related to the launch of new refinery capacity due to strict policy and regulation; and 4) tighter policies for environmental protection and carbon emissions.

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12-Month Rating	Definition	Coverage ¹	IB Services ²
Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	54%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 31 March 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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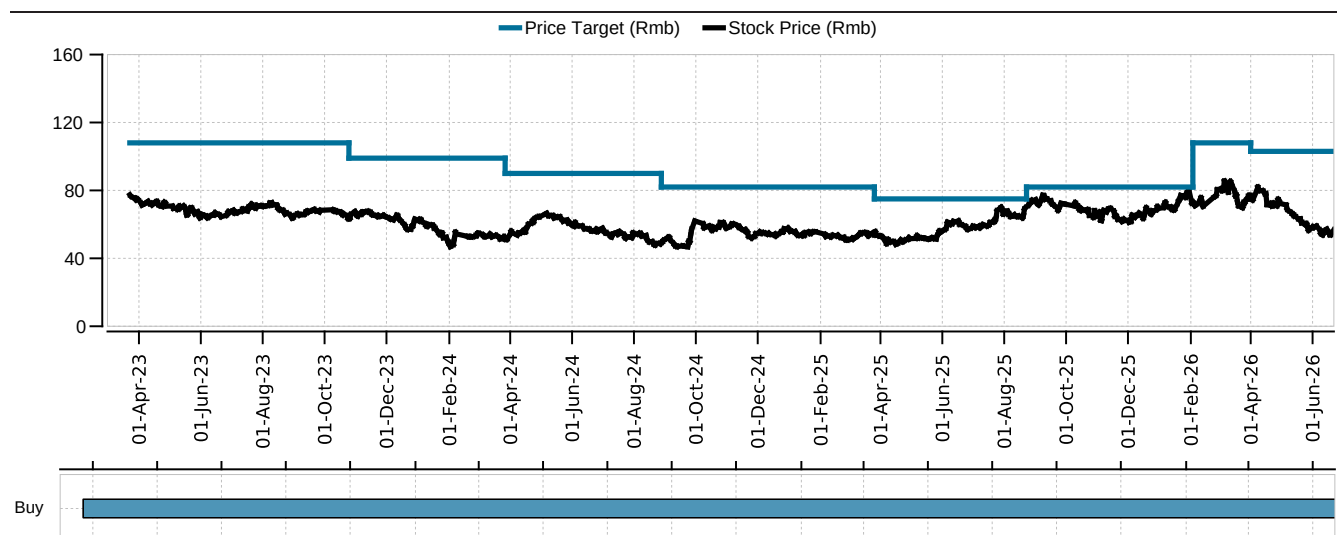
Company Disclosures

Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Jiangsu Yangnong Chemical	600486.SS	Buy	Rmb56.84	22 Jun 2026
Tongkun Group	601233.SS	Buy	Rmb23.09	22 Jun 2026
Wanhua Chemical Group	600309.SS	Buy	Rmb74.30	22 Jun 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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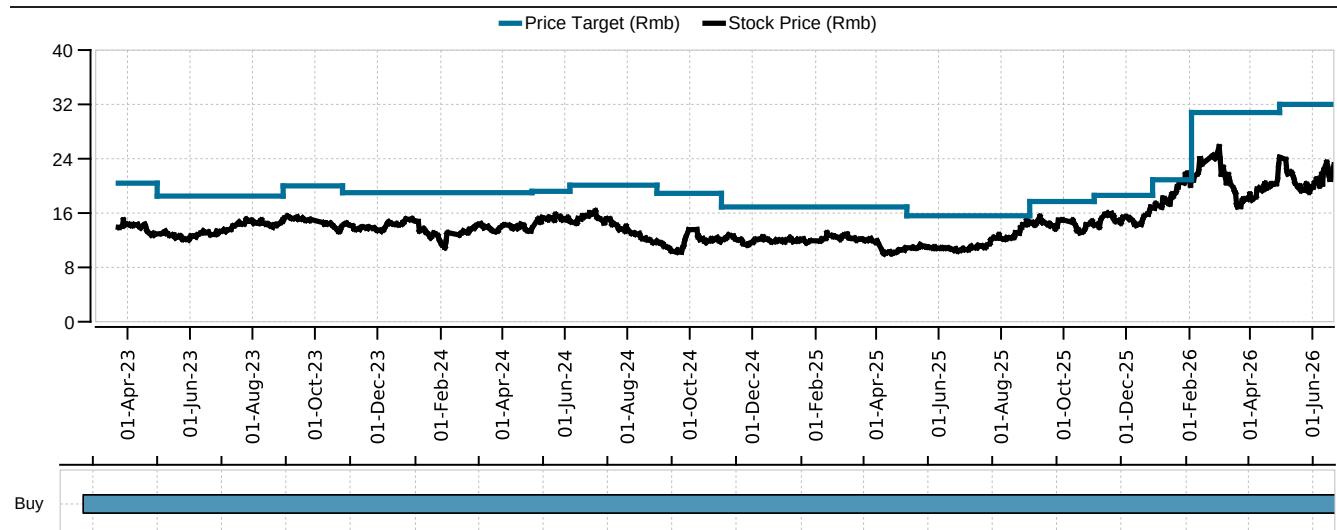
Jiangsu Yangnong Chemical (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-03-22	78.50	108.00	Buy
2023-10-24	63.52	99.00	Buy
2024-03-26	52.81	90.00	Buy
2024-08-27	48.52	82.00	Buy
2025-03-25	54.00	75.00	Buy
2025-08-22	69.88	82.00	Buy
2026-02-02	72.42	108.00	Buy
2026-03-31	75.00	103.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 22-Jun-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

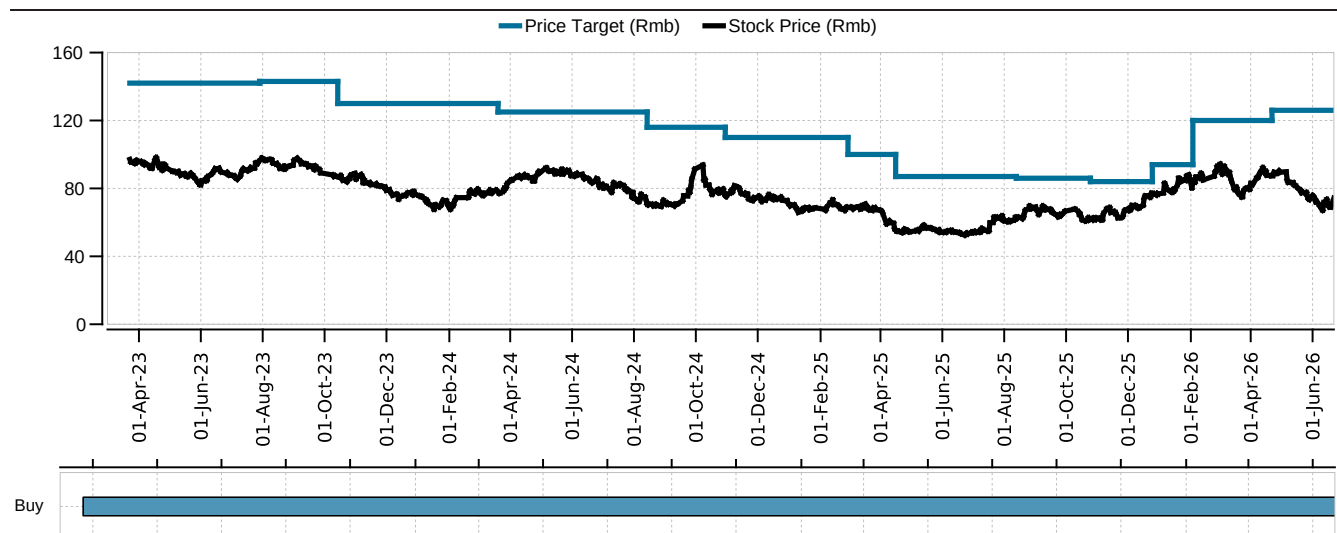
Tongkun Group (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-03-22	14.01	20.40	Buy
2023-04-29	12.90	18.50	Buy
2023-08-30	14.93	20.00	Buy
2023-10-27	14.01	19.00	Buy
2024-04-29	13.37	19.20	Buy
2024-06-05	15.08	20.10	Buy
2024-08-29	11.71	18.90	Buy
2024-10-31	11.78	16.90	Buy
2025-04-30	10.88	15.60	Buy
2025-08-28	14.42	17.70	Buy
2025-10-30	14.42	18.60	Buy
2025-12-26	16.85	20.90	Buy
2026-02-02	20.09	30.80	Buy
2026-04-29	23.06	32.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 22-Jun-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Wanhua Chemical Group (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-03-22	97.85	142.00	Buy
2023-07-28	95.71	143.00	Buy

Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-10-13	87.08	130.00	Buy
2024-03-19	78.58	125.00	Buy
2024-08-13	73.01	116.00	Buy
2024-10-29	76.84	110.00	Buy
2025-02-27	68.92	100.00	Buy
2025-04-15	56.26	87.00	Buy
2025-08-12	62.90	86.00	Buy
2025-10-24	61.45	84.00	Buy
2025-12-24	77.07	94.00	Buy
2026-02-02	80.33	120.00	Buy
2026-04-21	87.49	126.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 22-Jun-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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